bearer missing, and had to be carried out unconscious from the battlefield due to his many wounds. Fighting not only the enemy but also the unfamiliar, swampy terrain, and the faltering resolve of the Mughal troops, Munim Khan nonetheless rallied his forces and achieved a decisive victory. Daud Khan submitted, and in a specially constructed ceremonial tent, formally surrendered to Munim Khan. In an elaborately orchestrated ceremony Daud Khan, once Sultan of Bengal, untied his sword and set it aside while Munim Khan presented the Afghan with a Mughal sword, an embroidered belt, and a cloak purportedly worn by Akbar, thus 'incorporating' Daud Khan into the body of the emperor. Wearing the cloak and the sword, Daud Khan then turned his face to the faraway Mughal capital at Fatehpur Sikri and prostrated himself.

Despite the freighted symbology of Daud Khan's surrender, conditions on the ground in Bengal would remain explosive for decades:

> …seizing the capital and possessing the land were two different matters. While Mun'im Khan and Raja Todar Mal…were in Tanda reorganizing the revenue administration of the newly conquered province, thousands of Afghans melted into the forested Bengali hinterland, where for the next forty years they continued to hold out against the new regime. There they attracted a host of dissidents, including Muslim and Hindu zamindars, Portuguese renegades, and tribal chieftains, all of whom perceived the Chaghatai Turks from Upper India as foreigners and usurpers.

On a more prosaic note, to achieve victory, bribery had also been resorted to, bringing many of the Bengal noblemen over to the Mughal cause and diluting the power of the Bengal army. Raja Todar Mal had advocated the use of bribes, writing that 'the method to restrain the faction was to send money by one who was loyal and smooth-tongued'. Abu'l Fazl noted with satisfaction that this had 'quieted the slaves to gold'.

In Fatehpur Sikri his many victories and successes, dreams made reality, seemed to weigh on Akbar. So much had been obtained, seemingly effortlessly, in the past few years. Akbar had subdued Rajasthan, Gujarat, Bihar, and Bengal. He had scattered the Uzbeks, the mirzas, and the Afghans. He had wrought a huge empire into a cohesive unit. He had three golden sons, a glittering new capital, and he was only thirty-three years old. Always supremely confident of his purpose on earth, Akbar now wanted